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Candidate thesis brief for the Director of Enterprise AI Adoption · Russell Dudek

THE ROLE BEHIND THE TITLE

SupplyHouse is not hiring a tool curator. It is hiring an enterprise adoption operator who can align business value, technical readiness, human authority, enablement, governance and measurement across a fast-growing, people-first company.

PUBLICLY VISIBLE STARTING POINT

Growth pressure

SupplyHouse and KKR described a long-term growth partnership intended to expand operations and enhance service while maintaining culture.

Operating scale

Public company information cites 250,000+ SKUs, 500+ brands, seven million customers served and two-day reach to 98% of the U.S.

AI proof point

RELEX reports that AI-enabled forecasting and replenishment reduced manual work and improved supply-chain outcomes across four fulfillment centers.

These are public-context signals, not assumptions about undisclosed strategy, budgets, maturity or internal performance.

CENTRAL OPERATING CONTRADICTIONS

TENSION	WHAT THE CURRENT PATTERN MAY PROTECT	WHAT UNRESOLVED TENSION CAN COST	OPERATING ANSWER
Speed / trust	Safety, quality, employee confidence	Slow value realization or shadow use	Bounded pilots with explicit authority, controls and evidence
Enterprise / local	Functional expertise and autonomy	Duplication, inconsistent risk and weak reuse	Shared commissioning standard; local business ownership
Automation / agency	Human judgment and accountability	Persistent toil or fear-driven resistance	Augment work; name the human decision and escalation path
Activity / outcome	Visible momentum and experimentation	Tool counts without business value	Score workflow, quality, confidence and economic evidence

CANDIDATE POSITIONING

Rare integrated fit: 20+ years of operations and engineering leadership; frontline change at Amazon scale; AI-readiness and agentic-workflow design; current AI-first operating transformation in robotics; high-reliability quality systems; and communication across executives, technical teams and frontline workers.

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The AI Adoption Manifold

A commissioning system for enterprise AI

WHY A MANIFOLD

In plumbing and HVAC, a manifold distributes shared capacity to multiple circuits while preserving local control. Enterprise AI needs the same discipline: one set of standards and reusable services, multiple business-owned workflows, and evidence returned to the enterprise.

FIVE COMMISSIONING CONDITIONS

1 · Work value
A specific workflow outcome is worth changing, with a credible business owner and baseline.

2 · Data and control
Context is usable, access is bounded, privacy and security obligations are explicit.

3 · Human authority
The person who decides, approves, overrides and escalates remains named.

4 · Enablement
Users practice the workflow, understand limits and have support when reality diverges.

5 · Evidence
Quality, adoption, confidence, workflow and economic measures determine whether to scale.

Return learning
Reusable prompts, components, controls, training and failure modes improve the next circuit.

OPERATING RHYTHM

INTAKE — **Observe the work before naming the tool.**
Gemba-style workflow observation, employee interviews, friction evidence and consequence mapping.

COMMISSION — **Make ownership and evidence explicit.**
Business case, authority map, control review, adoption owner, evaluation plan and stop conditions.

PRACTICE — **Teach inside the role.**
Role-based exercises, sandbox, champions, office hours, visible escalation and real exception rehearsal.

OPERATE — **Measure behavior and outcomes.**
Usage depth, quality, confidence, workflow performance, exceptions, risk and economic evidence.

PATTERN — **Scale only what earned it.**
Reusable playbook, supported components, ownership model and an executive scale/hold/stop decision.

SUGGESTED ENTERPRISE SCORECARD

DIMENSION	LEADING SIGNALS	OUTCOME EVIDENCE
Adoption	Eligible users activated; depth and frequency; completion of role practice	Sustained use in the target workflow; reduced workarounds
Confidence	User confidence, psychological safety, clarity of limits and escalation	Appropriate reliance; fewer avoidable overrides or silent failures
Workflow	Cycle time, touches, handoffs, backlog, rework	Faster or better work without shifted burden downstream
Quality / risk	Evaluation pass rate, exception types, control compliance	Stable quality, auditable actions and bounded incidents
Value	Capacity released, cost avoided, revenue or service hypothesis	Validated economic impact with a named baseline

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Interview case and executive discovery

How I would make the fit testable

IMMEDIATE CONTRIBUTION PROFILE

Enterprise adoption architecture

- Use-case portfolio and commissioning criteria
- AI ambassadors and role-based enablement
- CoE structure and functional decision rights
- Adoption, confidence, risk and value scorecard

Operating credibility

- Amazon frontline and launch leadership
- AI-first operations in robotics
- High-reliability engineering and quality systems
- Distributed commercial and logistics modernization

STRONGEST PLAUSIBLE EXECUTIVE CONCERN

The useful question is not whether Russell has carried the exact same title inside an identical e-commerce enterprise. It is whether he can integrate AI fluency, enterprise change, operating rigor, frontline empathy and executive value discipline quickly enough to build the function. His verified record supports that integrated capability without requiring an inflated claim of prior ownership over an undisclosed enterprise AI platform.

Make it testable: Give Russell one real workflow, one stakeholder set and the relevant constraints. In a working session, he will frame the outcome, surface the adoption tension, map authority, propose commissioning evidence and identify what must be learned before a pilot begins.

EXECUTIVE QUESTIONS

1. Where has AI already earned trust at SupplyHouse, and what behavior made the adoption durable?
2. Which business outcome would make this role undeniably successful after twelve months?
3. What should be centralized: tools, architecture, governance, enablement, measurement—or only parts of each?
4. Where do employees currently experience the most avoidable work, and what does that friction protect?
5. How do IT, Data, Legal, HR and business leaders divide authority today?
6. What will the Board expect to see beyond pilot activity?
7. Which employee population is most at risk of receiving less enablement or less benefit from AI?
8. What would make the executive team decide to stop an AI initiative?

CLOSING PROPOSITION

I would not begin by asking SupplyHouse to adopt AI. I would begin by understanding the work, identifying where AI can genuinely help, and installing a system that lets each use case earn trust and scale through evidence.